Modern Art & Ideas ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas

Welcome to the Course

- ● Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas
  Video • 1 min
- ● Welcome to the Course!
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ **What is Modern Art?**
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ MoMA Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Are You a K-12 educator?
  Reading • 10 min

Review & Reflect

- ○ What theme are you excited to explore?
  Graded Assignment • 15 min
- ○ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection
  Reading • 10 min

Module 2
Places & Spaces

Module 3
Art & Identity

Module 4
Transforming Everyday Objects

Module 5
Module 5: Art & Society

Module 6
Course Conclusion

What is Modern Art?

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What is Modern Art?

Art made from the 1880s to the 1970s—a time marked by the growth of cities, the rise of industry, a surge in technologies, and the development of mass media. During this period, everyday life changed for people around the world. Artists of diverse backgrounds contributed to this change, experimenting with new subjects, styles, materials, and techniques in their works.

What it meant to be "modern" depended on when and where an artist worked. Some artists developed new ways of representing external realities and inner experiences. Others broke down boundaries between art, architecture, design, and craft. Many confronted political turmoil or social and economic injustice. But across distinct eras and geographies, modern artists shared a spirit of innovation. They challenged traditional ways of making art, reimagining who art is for and what it could be.

What is contemporary art?

Art made in the present and recent past, currently understood as roughly 1980 to today. While contemporary artists come from different backgrounds, explore a wide range of ideas, and use different materials and techniques, many explore the social and political issues of our time.

Contemporary artists often explore the category of art itself. Some appropriate existing images and objects, blurring boundaries between art and popular culture. Others experiment with mediums like video, performance, and installation. Some artists critique art institutions, including museums and galleries, asking questions about how art is displayed, discussed, and circulated. Still others include references to older artworks or artistic styles.

Whether reflecting on the past or responding to the present, contemporary artists make work that invites us to think, feel, and talk about the world in new ways.

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